



Mobile Masons actively engaged in the housing reconstruction of one of the vulnerable beneficiaries at ward-10, Belkotgadhi Rural Municipality, Nuwakot District using Hollow Concrete Block. She has received a second tranche of the housing grant from the Government of Nepal.

Photo: Govinda Bhatta, Social Mobilizer Belkotgadhi, Nuwakot

HIGHLIGHTS

- [The Path to Housing Recovery-Nepal Earthquake 2015: Housing Reconstruction](#)
- [A Summary Report of the virtual and abridged Asia Shelter Forum \(ASF\) meeting, 29 November, 2020](#)
- [NRA Notice on the Final Tranche disbursement deadline](#)
- [NDRRMA in the process of drafting a grant disbursement procedural guideline for the housing reconstruction and rehabilitation of disaster affected household](#)
- [COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population \(MoHP\)](#)

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF STORY: Aayush Darlami Magar, Mobile Mason at Khanikhola Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok



*Aayush Darlami Magar,
Mobile Mason
Khanikhola Rural Municipality,
Kavrepalanchok*

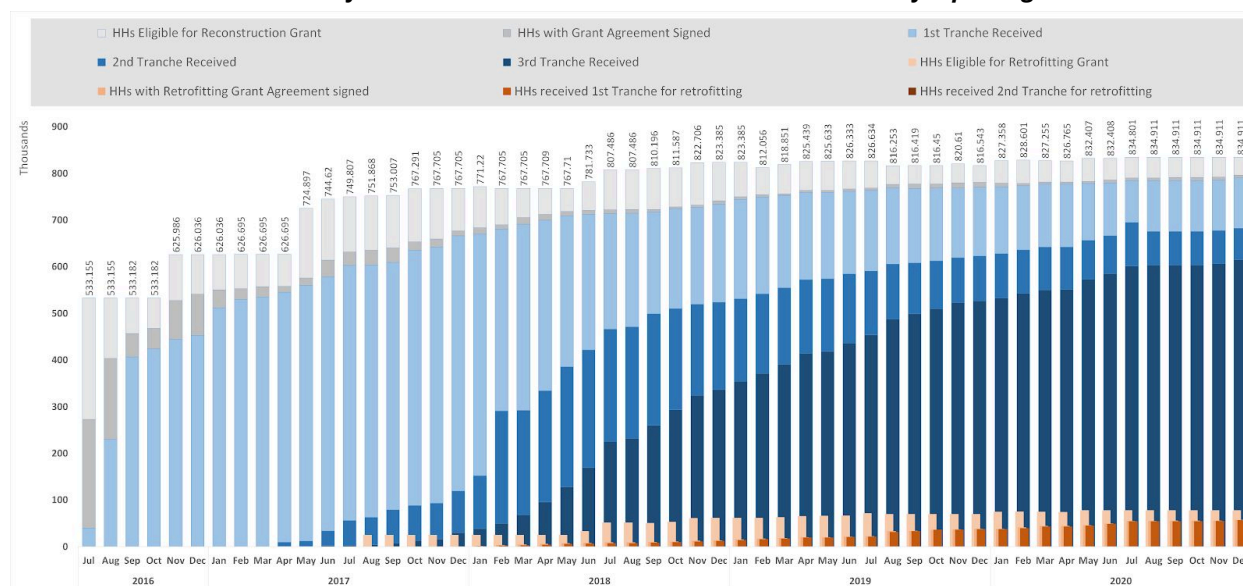
Aayush Darlami Magar, Mobile Mason at Khanikhola Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: A young and energetic Ayush is a mobile mason, who was deployed from DLPIU since February 2020. He works together with seven other mobile masons and two social mobilizers. As yet, under his leadership, house reconstruction of three vulnerable beneficiaries has completed. He thinks vulnerable house reconstruction can get its pace if the municipality and the DLPIU publish vulnerable beneficiaries list as early as possible.

NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMAI and Building. Grant Disbursement Data, as of 28 December 2020:

Reconstruction Grant	19 October	30 November	28 December
Total No. Eligible HHs	834911	834911	834911
HHs Enrolled	791534	791787	796282
HHs Received 1st Tranche	784556	785078	790266
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	675613	677557	681953
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	603555	606505	614642
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	N/A	N/A	N/A
Houses Completed	N/A	N/A	N/A
HHs with Completion Certificate	N/A	N/A	N/A
Retrofit Grant	19 October	30 November	28 December
Total No. Eligible HHs	78033	78033	78033
HHs Enrolled	55282	55649	57319
HHs Received 1st Tranche	54497	54859	56478
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	302	303	332

***N/A indicates that the information source was not accessible at the time of reporting**



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMAI CLPIU data as of 28 Dec 2020.

The Path to Housing Recovery-Nepal Earthquake 2015: Housing Reconstruction: HRRP published the fifth edition “The Path to Housing Recovery-Nepal Earthquake 2015: Housing Reconstruction.” This document presents a timeline of key achievements and activities so far in the housing recovery, including a pre-earthquake section to highlight the decades of work on earthquake preparedness and response in Nepal. The timeline aims at contributing to increased awareness and understanding of the huge number of policies, procedures, and guidelines that have been developed for the recovery process. It also highlights the winter and monsoon seasons and COVID-19 pandemic impacting the housing construction seasons. This document also captures the progress, milestones and significant events during the recovery period from April 2015 till November 2020 along with milestones between 1934 till 2015 that have impacts on the current recovery period.

National Disaster Risk Reduction Management Authority (NDRRMA) announced that it is in the process of drafting a grant disbursement procedural guideline for the housing reconstruction and rehabilitation of disaster affected household:

NDRRMA Executive Meeting held on 6 October 2020 (2077 Asoj 20) decided to develop a grant disbursement procedural guideline to disaster affected households entitled “Grant Disbursement Procedural Guideline- 2077 for Disaster Affected Households.” The proposed guideline will come into effect after the approval from the cabinet. The guideline reportedly includes a basis for identifying disaster affected households, their selection process, grant types and tranche disbursement process for the reconstruction of their house.

NRA Notice on the Final Tranche disbursement deadline

According to important notice issued by the NRA,

1. Beneficiaries who are eligible for reconstruction and retrofit grant are requested to sign the partner agreement by 15 December 2020 (end of Mangsir 2077), and receive first tranche by 30 December 2020 (Poush 15, 2077).
2. Beneficiaries who have received the first tranche must start their housing reconstruction and submit an application to the local government for verification process by 12 February 2021 (end of Magh 2077).

3. All reconstruction and retrofitting beneficiaries must submit an application for verification process to the local level government by 14 May 2021 (end of Baisakh 2078) to access third or the final tranche.

For more information, all concerned are requested to contact the National Reconstruction Authority or their respective DLPIU Offices.

COVID-19 live updates from Ministry of Health and Population (MoHP)

According to the Ministry of Health & Population (MOHP) [website](#) data, as of 27 December 2020, total cumulative new cases are 258,181 (male- 168,264 and female- 89,917), out of which 6493 confirmed cases are undergoing medical treatment in isolation and 249,863 are discharged after recovery. So far 1825 have died due to COVID-19 in Nepal. There are a total of 369 in quarantine facilities.

The MoHP has operationalized two call centers **1115 (from 6 am to 10 pm)** and **1133 (24 hours)** to provide counselling services regarding COVID-19 prevention and treatment.

A Summary Report of the virtual and abridged Asia Shelter Forum (ASF) meeting, 29 November, 2020:

The Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD) and National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), and Department of Urban Development and Building Construction (DUDBC) with support from the Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) as the focal agency of organizing committee, and Catholic Relief Service (CRS), IFRC, Global Shelter Cluster, Habitat for Humanity, IOM, EU, and NGO federation as the major contributor for Asia Shelter Forum, organized virtual and abridged Asia Shelter Forum Meeting on 29 November 2020 in Nepal. The ASF 2020 opening session was chaired by Dr. Ramesh Prasad Singh, the Secretary of the Ministry of Urban Development. He stressed on the need for strong coordination and collaboration among the partners and Regional Governments for effective disaster response. Er. Mani Ram Gelal, Director General, Department of Urban Development and Building Construction-Nepal, welcomed all the dignitaries and the participants followed by the opening remarks from the Government Diplomats namely Mr. Md. Atiqul Haque, Department of Director General, People's Republic of Bangladesh; Rento U. Solidum, Jr. Officer In-charge, Under Secretary, The Republic of Philippines; Mr. Jen Galfand, IFRC, Head of Office, Indonesia; and Mr.

Muhamad Safii Nasuton, Director, Ministry of Social Affairs, The Republic of Indonesia, who officially handed over the responsibility of hosting ASF 2020 to the Government of Nepal, as an organizer of the event. The NRA CEO, Mr. Sushil Gyewali delivered keynote remarks during the closing ceremony highlighting the need for greater collaboration and cooperation among the Regional Countries for post-disaster recovery and reconstruction. The participants of the ASF thoroughly discussed on five sessions namely Shelter Cluster coordination mechanism and its initiative in the region; the role of shelter and settlements in response to COVID-19; Urban housing reconstruction in Nepal; Multi-hazard shelter needs and response and Nepal retrofitting and regional experience among others. The Virtual and Abridged ASF 2020 provided a unique platform to capture learning & innovations across the Asia-Pacific that will guide the Region on achieving major targets and indicators of safe and resilient shelter through a series of milestones. The Forum also explored best practices and community-driven shelter initiatives along with shelter recovery initiatives in urban recovery, retrofitting, and multi-hazard shelter needs and responses including the shelter response in context of COVID-19. More than 300 participants around the world attended the Asia Shelter Forum Workshop virtually and physically on 29 November 2020. [Click here Video recording](#)

The session highlights along with the video recording is mentioned hereunder.

The first session, Shelter Cluster Coordination Mechanism and its initiatives in the region, highlighted the global shelter cluster mechanism including the role of global Shelter Coordination, response, and capacity building of different government and non-government organizations for humanitarian assistance. [Click here Video recording](#)

The second session, the Role of Shelter & Settlements in Response to COVID-19, highlighted on emerging shelter issues of living conditions of vulnerable and marginalized populations, eviction issue, mainstreaming economic recovery in shelter programs, to be addressed in the context of COVID-19 primarily focusing on the people's right to an adequate standard of living, which requires, at a minimum, adequate shelter, clothing, food, nutrition and other necessary conditions of care and dignified home for overall well-being of humans. Shelter Cluster Nepal initiatives for COVID-19 response were also delivered. [Click here Video recording](#).

The third session, Urban Housing Recovery in Nepal, highlighted urban housing and recovery in Nepal including experience sharing from India, Chile, Nepal and Sri Lanka. Nepal's experience was shared where a research findings from combined study (qualitative & quantitative) revealed housing finance, financial process and policy, and land etc. has made urban housing recovery complex and slow. Some of the ways forward suggested to overcome such issues are improving access to low-cost loans, research on urban technology, conservation of traditional architecture etc. [Click here Video recording](#)

The fourth session, Nepal Retrofitting & Regional Experiences, covered experience sharing of retrofitting practitioners from Asia Pacific region; Nepal, Bhutan, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Indonesia, and Philippines. It was highlighted that physical demonstration of retrofitting helped people to understand more on retrofitting techniques. [Click here Video recording](#)

The fifth session, Multi-Hazard Shelter Needs and Response, underlined the importance of integrated assessment of multiple hazards for effective shelter management. In this session, the presenters from Phillipine, Myanmar, Bangladesh and Nepal shared various aspects of Geo-risk initiatives, Geo-hazard assessment services, resilient and climate smart designs and responses through a community-led approach including social, environment and economic dimensions for project interventions. [Click here for video recording](#)

On behalf of the ASF Organizing Committee, Mr. Marc D' Silva, Regional Director, CRS, stressed on the importance of government leadership to bring CBOs and I/NGOs together to share, reflect and identify the most appropriate housing solutions, especially for the most vulnerable in our societies. He reiterated that key ASF working groups came together on areas of urban issues, retrofitting, COVID-19 settlement response, and multi-hazard response, and the outcomes of these working groups will form the basis of the ASF 2021. [Click here for Video recording](#)

The Chief Guest, Er. Sushil Gyewali, Chief Executive Officer, NRA, highlighted the commitment for continued support in such regional collaboration and expressed that shelter is multi-disciplinary efforts, which needs strong commitment and collaboration from all the sectors; governmental, non-governmental, and private sector are required for

better shelter and its emergency response. Mr. Surendra Mohan Shrestha, Joint Secretary of the MOUD, who presided over the closing session, offered a vote of thanks and praised the beauty of this forum to discuss challenges and identify solutions for our communities.

[Click here for Video recording.](#)

As a convener of the International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction (ICNR-2020/2021), Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha, informed the road map for the International Conference planned for April 2021 followed by ASF Shelter week. He requested all the participants to block their calendars for shelter week. [Click here for Video recording](#)

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

In **Lalitpur**, private housing reconstruction work is near to be completed at ward 4 of Mahankal Rural Municipality. More than 90% of houses are built with stones and mud mortar. The completion of housing reconstruction will be announced on 24 January 2021 in participation of all concerned focal stakeholders from Lalitpur district. The Building Office is tracking beneficiaries that have converted housing types to reconstruction from retrofitting. Mobile masons are providing case-by-case technical support to vulnerable beneficiaries on reconstruction.

In **Bhaktapur**, mobile mason are engaged in extending technical support to vulnerable beneficiaries on house reconstruction. Majority of such houses have a housing typology of the BMC wall system.

In **Kathmandu**, a meeting with NRA was held on 22 December 2020 to discuss the third tranche's payment release of beneficiaries supported by LWF in Shankharapur Municipality. Till date, 106 beneficiaries have applied to change from retrofitting to reconstruction. The District Coordination Committee has approved a final list of beneficiaries under the vulnerable category of NRA and they forwarded vulnerable beneficiaries list to CLPIU for data entry in LMBIS. Similarly, the lists of beneficiaries who have not signed in reconstruction grant agreement are also forwarded to CLPIU. DLPIU Building has planned to organize Mason Training in all the municipalities of Kathmandu district. The mason training video prepared by CLPIU-Building will be circulated to all the municipalities, which

would be the basic medium of training. Follow-up with focal person on tranche return from beneficiaries of Chandragiri Municipality and Gokarneshwor Municipality supported by Himalayan Dana Foundation has been completed. In this regard, concerned ward offices and beneficiaries were contacted and are encouraged to return the tranche amount.

In **Sindhupalchowk**, GMaLI office has resumed tranche distribution activity. They also finalized a contract agreement of seven 'Gumba', which was damaged in Nepal Earthquake 2015. GMaLI has also issued a request letter for I/NGOs on 15 December 2020 stating to submit reconstruction work progress. DLPIU building is working on tranche certification, CS data entry file, and file management of solved IDA issues. Moreover, DLPIU building is parallelly doing supervision of the integrated settlement and the government building like hospitals and schools.

In **Rasuwa**, out of 275 eligible vulnerable beneficiaries in the district, 205 beneficiaries have received top-up support through Nepal Red Cross Society for reconstruction. So far, 229 vulnerable beneficiaries have received all the subsequent tranche from the Government of Nepal, where 254 beneficiaries received the first tranche and 237 beneficiaries received the second tranche.

In **Nuwakot**, retrofitting progress is agitated because the majority of beneficiaries have requested GMaLI for house reconstruction rather than retrofitting. GMaLI Office is verifying requests to finalize conversion types. Till now 16 beneficiaries have completed the houses retrofitting. Of the 1,169 eligible reconstruction beneficiaries in Nuwakot, 1,112 received first tranche, 1,009 received second tranche and 874 have received third tranche. Similarly, Nepal Red Cross Society has rendered top-up support to 75 vulnerable beneficiaries of Kispang Rural Municipality. Altogether 60 beneficiaries have received approval from Panchakanya Rural Municipality, Suryagadhi Rural Municipality and Bidur Municipality for extra top up support. Data verification and approval processes from rural municipalities & municipalities are under process.

In **Lamjung**, NRA visited Lamjung district on 12 December 2020 to inaugurate the library of Sundarbazar Agricultural Campus. After the inauguration program, NRA did a meeting with DLPIUs (GMaLI, Building, and Education) to get an update on reconstruction and discuss major challenges that came across during reconstruction. In the meeting, DLPIUs raised

concern of chances of duplication that might be incurred in future due to lack of reconstruction beneficiaries details supported by partner organizations immediately after the Nepal Earthquake 2015. In this regard, NRA also assured DLPIUs to provide them with a proper dataset listing the details of partners working in Lamjung district. The meeting ended with a takeaway from the NRA team. The NRA suggested DLPIU-Education to improvise building construction, increase the number of construction material tests of brick, and rebar. GMaLI has also commenced tracking and verification of vulnerable beneficiaries. Out of 552 vulnerable beneficiaries of the district, 251 beneficiaries have received all subsequent tranches from the Government of Nepal. Tracking of remaining 301 vulnerable beneficiaries has also been completed. Disaggregation of Rural Municipality/Municipality wise vulnerable data is completed and those disaggregated data is sent to respective municipalities for the verification process. Upon the verification from Palikas, the remaining vulnerable name list will be presented in the District Coordination Meeting for approval process to send for central level for additional top-up release. On 9 December 2020, coordination meeting with COPPADES and DLPIU-GMaLI was conducted to discuss additional top-up support for vulnerable beneficiaries. Accordingly, COPPADES has selected 800 vulnerable households (390 HHs are from Rainas Urban Municipality and 410 are from Dordi Rural Municipality) recommended by the ward for additional top-up support, however they are not listed in NRA vulnerable category. A coordination meeting with Choice Humanitarian Nepal and DLPIU-GMaLI was completed on 16 December 2020 to discuss tranche duplication. Choice Humanitarian Nepal facilitated complete house reconstruction of beneficiaries. However, five beneficiaries have already received reconstruction tranches from the NRA. This has raised tranche duplication issues. The DLPIU-GMaLI Chief offered two solutions to Choice Humanitarian Nepal; (i) either convince five beneficiaries to return tranches received from NRA and support them as per their working modality, or (ii) to let the government of Nepal provide reconstruction housing grant to them along with additional top-up support if they are included in the NRA's vulnerable list.

In **Kavrepalanchowk**, GMaLI office is working on vulnerable data collection and is doing continuous follow-up with municipalities for collection of vulnerable data. Accordingly, GMaLI office has received more than 200 beneficiaries from municipalities. Those beneficiaries list will be presented as an approval agenda for the next DCC meeting. This

month GMAI office has distributed the first tranche to 199 beneficiaries, second tranche to 599 beneficiaries, and 933 beneficiaries received the third tranche. Eight beneficiaries are from the district also enlisted into earthquake beneficiaries list from NRA grievance list.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward No. 4, Suryabinayak Municipality, Bhaktapur: Single storey with four roomed BMC house. The homeowner received all the tranches from a government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



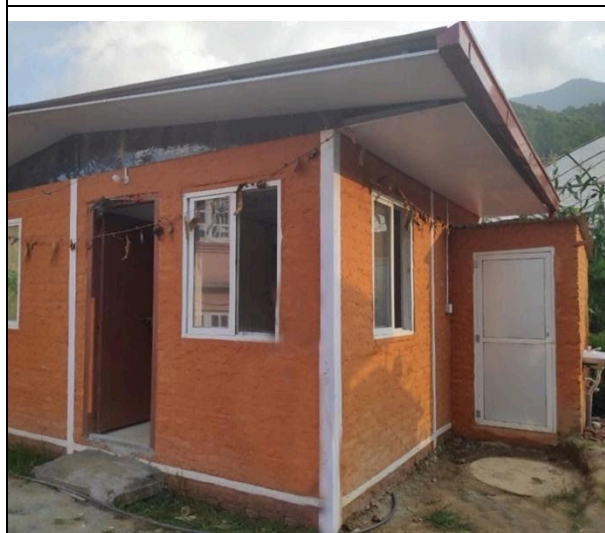
Ward 3, Jiri Municipality, Dolakha: Single storey house made up of stone in cement mortar on RCC bands with an attic. The homeowner has received all the tranches from the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward 1, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Dhading: BMC single story house with two rooms is under construction. The house owner has received the second tranche from a government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward 1, Chandragiri Municipality, Kathmandu: One storey load bearing brick in cement mortar structure with CGI roof. Himalaya Dana Foundation supported house reconstruction.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward 5, Khanikhola Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: Stone in cement house. The house owner has received all the three tranches from the government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur Cluster Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward 3, Makwanpurgadhi Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: Block Masonry single storey house with two rooms. The homeowner has received all three tranches from the Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Lamjung Cluster Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward 2, Rainas Municipality, Lamjung: Single storey brick masonry in cement mortar house. It is a two room compliant house with horizontal and vertical RCC bands at all levels. House reconstruction is completed and the house owner has also received all three tranches from the NRA.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Solukhumbu Cluster Monthly Report, 26 Nov – 23 Dec 2020



Ward-6, Mapee Dodhkoshi Rural Municipality, Solukhumbu: Stone in mud mortar with wooden band. The house owner received all three tranches and is in the process to receive a completion certificate.

HRRP District Coordination Team Rasuwa, Nuwakot Monthly Report, 26 Nov - 23 Dec 2020



Ward 10, Belkotgadhi Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: Hollow Concrete Block Structure is under construction. The house owner has received a second tranche from Government Housing Grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchowk Monthly Report, 26 Nov - 23 Dec 2020



Ward 5, Panchpokhari Thangpal Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchowk: Load Bearing structure Stone and Mud Mortar Masonry with RCC bands. The Homeowner has received a second tranche from Government Housing Grant.

FEATURED STORY



Aayush Darlami Magar, Mobile Mason at Khanikhola Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok:

A young and energetic Ayush is a mobile mason, who was deployed from DLPIU since February 2020. He has been continuously supporting and coordinating with beneficiaries of different wards inside the rural municipality for reconstruction and retrofitting.

He never hesitates to seek technical guidance from municipal engineers. Municipal and ward officials genuinely appreciate his learning attitude and are impressed with his mason skills. He is also grateful towards Municipal Focal Engineer, Er. Keshab Raj Adhikari for giving technical guidance.

He works together with seven other mobile masons and two social mobilizers. Under his leadership, house reconstruction of three vulnerable beneficiaries has been completed. He pays tribute to his team for tirelessly working and municipal authorities for offering constant technical advice because of which they are able to succeed in rebuilding houses of vulnerable beneficiaries.

He thinks vulnerable house reconstruction can get its pace if the municipality and the DLPIU publish vulnerable beneficiaries list as early as possible. He is passionate about his work and shows dedication to house reconstruction of disadvantaged groups in his village. According to him, vulnerable beneficiaries have limited financial resources because of which they are unable to reconstruct houses on time.

CASE STORY

Mr. Krishna Kumar Khatri, Resident of Jiri Municipality, Dolakha- Information Clinic (Story and Photo Credit-UNOPS)



Krishna K. Khatri is on top of the world these days. He is the first retrofitting beneficiary from Thalari Wada -8, Jiri Dolakha. He runs a shop in Jiri Bazaar with his wife and is a driver by profession. His house has been selected as a model house for retrofitting by Build Change. Engineering design of his house is made ready by engineers and all set for retrofitting. They are waiting for the right weather to bring in materials for the house since the roads are in bad condition after the rainfall. He shared his happiness with the BBC Media Action team and Build Change team and was happy to be setting a good example for his village.

At first, he had no knowledge on retrofitting, but programmes by Millijuli Nepali and Baliyo Ghar gave him more knowledge on retrofitting. His name was on the list of beneficiaries for one lakh only. He then went to the ward office and applied to check whether his house is suitable for retrofitting. When he got information from a concerned person that his house was being selected for the retrofitting, he was happy and excited for making his damaged house in new and strong form. He said, "I am emotionally attached to my 18 years old house as I personally built this house. My family life started here, and my family now lives

in the same house, so all memories are there in this house. I am glad that my old house remains the same but is new and stronger.” He has invited BBC Media Action Team to re-visit his house after retrofitting work is completed.

“Happy!! Going to leave temporary shelter”

Chanamati Sarki, 40,
Tarakeshwar Rural

Municipality ward number two, is a person with physical disability by birth. She needs regular support from others even for day-to-day work. The devastating earthquake had destroyed her house, which was constructed with the help



of family members. After the destruction, she resided one complete year in tarpaulin accommodation, which was not comfortable for living. She had bad and painstaking experiences during the rainy season. She got some foods, the tarpaulin and some winterization kits had received during the response period through partner organization.

After this year, she got some CGI sheets for building temporary shelter. Her family members and neighbors had supported constructing temporary shelter. This was better to live in than the previous one, but it was more severe during winter and hot days. She was mostly affected by mosquitoes in the rainy season and was always in fear of other reptiles like snakes. She hoped to get support from families and neighbors but most of the neighbors were busy with their construction. Therefore, she did not get any support at that time. She also signed a partnership agreement for house reconstruction and received NPR 50,000 but could not start her construction. After some ease in the construction period, one of her family members supported construction until the DPC level, and she got access to the second tranche and she repaid all loans borrowed during DPC construction. DPC was completed before 2 years, but she did not receive any support.

Deepak Shakya, a local social mobilizer, raised her issue in the village. He informed villagers about the extra top up support of NPR 50,000 for vulnerable beneficiaries. Then, one of the family members came in support for reconstruction until the tranche release. Three mobile masons and two volunteers were also involved in construction up to roof level. Now she seems happy looking at the newly constructed house, which has more facility and comfort than temporary shelter. She feels more secure than the previous one. She shows her thankfulness to volunteers and mobile masons of reconstruction.

“Shelter-Alo Palo” (Story Credit-NRCS)

“When I think about the earthquake now...” Parbati Ghale’s voice trails off before she continues. “At the time, I thought my life was over. I was so worried – what would I do with my children, where would we live, how would I raise them without a husband who could earn? But now I’m at peace.”

The April 2015 Nepal earthquake was particularly devastating for Parbati and her three sons. It took not only her home – as it did for 443 of the roughly 500 families living in the area of Thulogaun, Rasuwa – but also her husband’s life. He was one of 54 people who died in this small hillside community on that spring afternoon.

Living in a temporary shelter built in the remains of her old home, Parbati wasn’t sure how to start rebuilding. The NPR. 300,000/- shelter reconstruction grant from the Red Cross would help, but it wouldn’t cover everything. Then, in February 2017, the Red Cross invited Parbati and her neighbours to a meeting”.

They called us together and said: you should form a group,” says Parbati. The idea wasn’t a new one. For generations, families living on these steep, rocky slopes have taken turns helping each other with everything from harvesting crops to preparing for weddings to building houses. But in the aftermath of the earthquake, when every home in the area had been destroyed, everyone was at a loss where to even begin. The Red Cross team talked the homeowners through the rebuilding process, and helped them work out how much they could save if they took a ‘parma’ or “alo-palo” – literally turn by turn – approach, contributing unskilled labour to each other’s build sites rather than hiring workers. Volunteers helped map out a rotating schedule. The Red Cross also helped motivate

homeowners to join a group by providing a small stipend for snacks for each build team until the foundations were complete. This is part of the Utthan earthquake recovery program's 'community mobilization' approach, which helps communities articulate their needs and then find the resources – both from within their own community or from other sources – to address them.

The Alo Palo groups helped residents in Thulogaun unlock an underappreciated and overlooked resource: the power of women working together. Like in many other communities in Nepal, building is traditionally considered men's work. However, men are in short supply; some households, like Parbati's, are headed by widows or single mothers, and in many others the young men have gone abroad to earn money to send back to their families. Together, women found the confidence to work on build sites – breaking rocks for gravel, mixing and carrying cement, and digging foundations. "The Red Cross really advocated for involving women in the reconstruction," says Sushma Ghale, a member of the same Alo Palo group as Parbati.

Sushma and Parbati's neighbor and fellow group member Padam Bahadur Ghale estimated that he would have spent an additional NPR. 100,000/- on labour costs if his family hadn't decided to exchange labour. He's also proud that everyone in his group has a rebuilt home; "In our area, if a neighbor is in need, we don't just look after ourselves." Suntali Nepali, a member of another one of the 17 Alo Palo groups that formed all over Thulogaun, agrees. "It's because of these groups that the pace of rebuilding really picked up here," she says, "and it's made the bonds between neighbours even stronger."

"Without the labour exchange, I would only have had enough to rebuild if I took loans. But this way I didn't have to take loans, the reconstruction payments were enough," says Parbati. When the family was ready to move into their new, cement-and-brick two-room home, Parbati's school-aged sons made their own contribution: painting every single brick of the new house a different color.

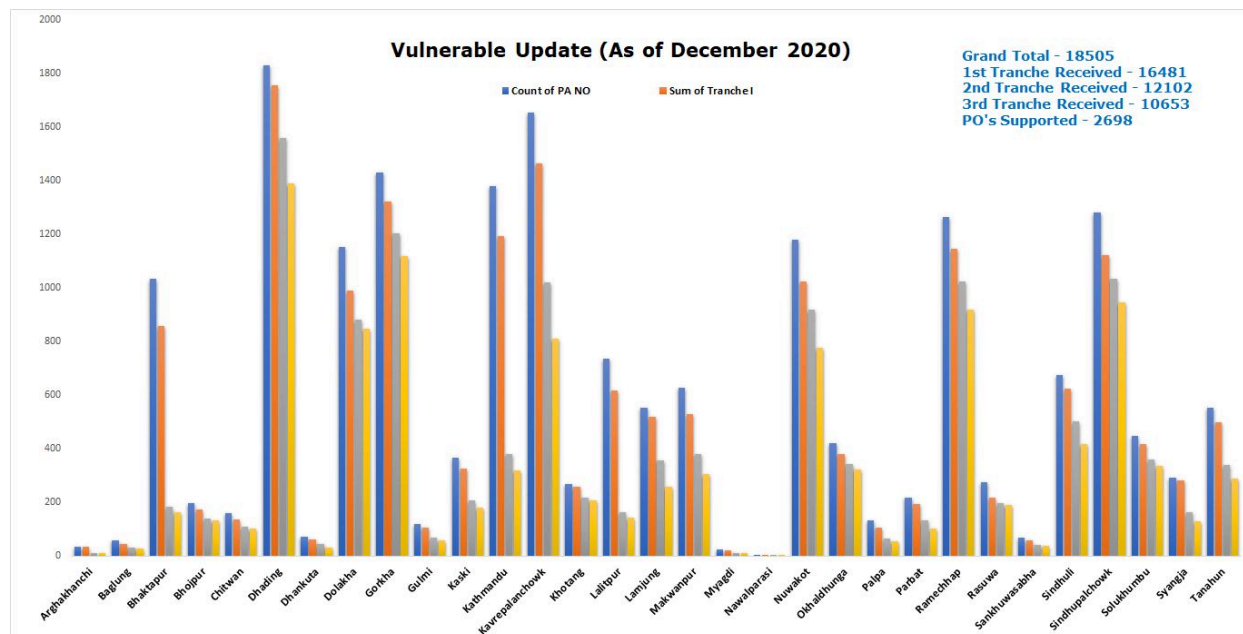
Households Grant Type Conversion

Number of households switching to grant type (December 2020): This data has been collected from the DLPIU offices by the HRRP District Coordination Teams. It will be updated as more information is received.

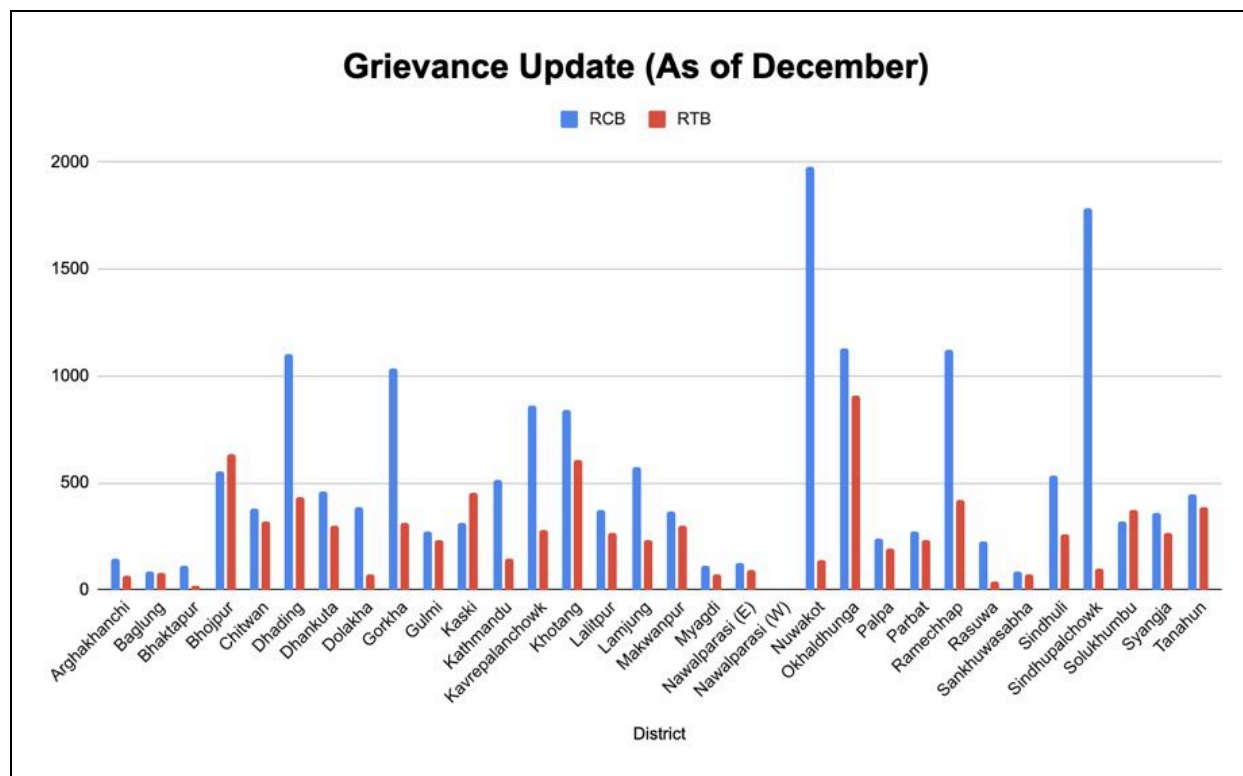
District	Reconstruction	Retrofitting
Bhaktapur	46	5
Dhading	7	
Dhankuta	25	0
Dolakha	47	11
Gorkha	71	26
Kavrepalanchok	154	5
Kathmandu	96	66
Khotang	4	0
Lalitpur	17	
Makwanpur	219	17
Nuwakot	27	3
Okhaldhunga	22	0
Ramechhap	2	0
Rasuwa	39	0
Sankhuwasabha	8	3
Sindhuli	1769	
Sindhupalchok	27	6
Syangja	2	3
Grand Total	2582	145

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction (December 2020): Of the total **18,505** NRA identified vulnerable households, 89% (**16,481**) have received the first tranche, 65% (12,102) have received the second tranche and 58% (**10,653**) have received the third tranche. In total 2,698 HHs have been supported by various partner organizations.



Grievance Update: As of December 2020 , **25,431** grievances have been addressed by NRA, out of which **17,116** HHs have been enlisted as reconstruction beneficiaries and **8,315** as retrofitting beneficiaries.



MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



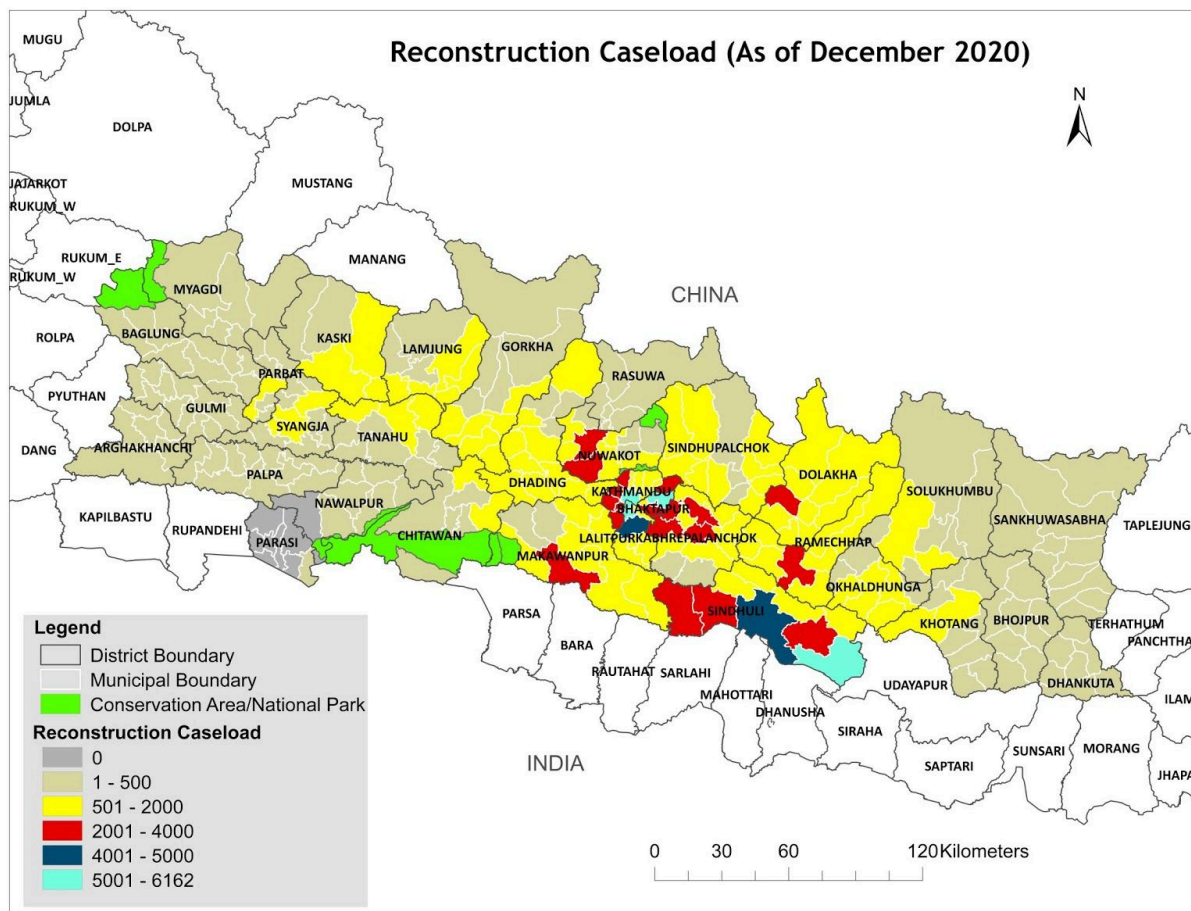
[Baliyo Ghar Surakshit Nepal | 6 December 2020](#): This episode focuses on Web-based workshop and virtual abridged Asia Shelter Forum 2020. This program airs on Nepal Television every Friday 7:00 PM and every Saturday 10:30 AM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

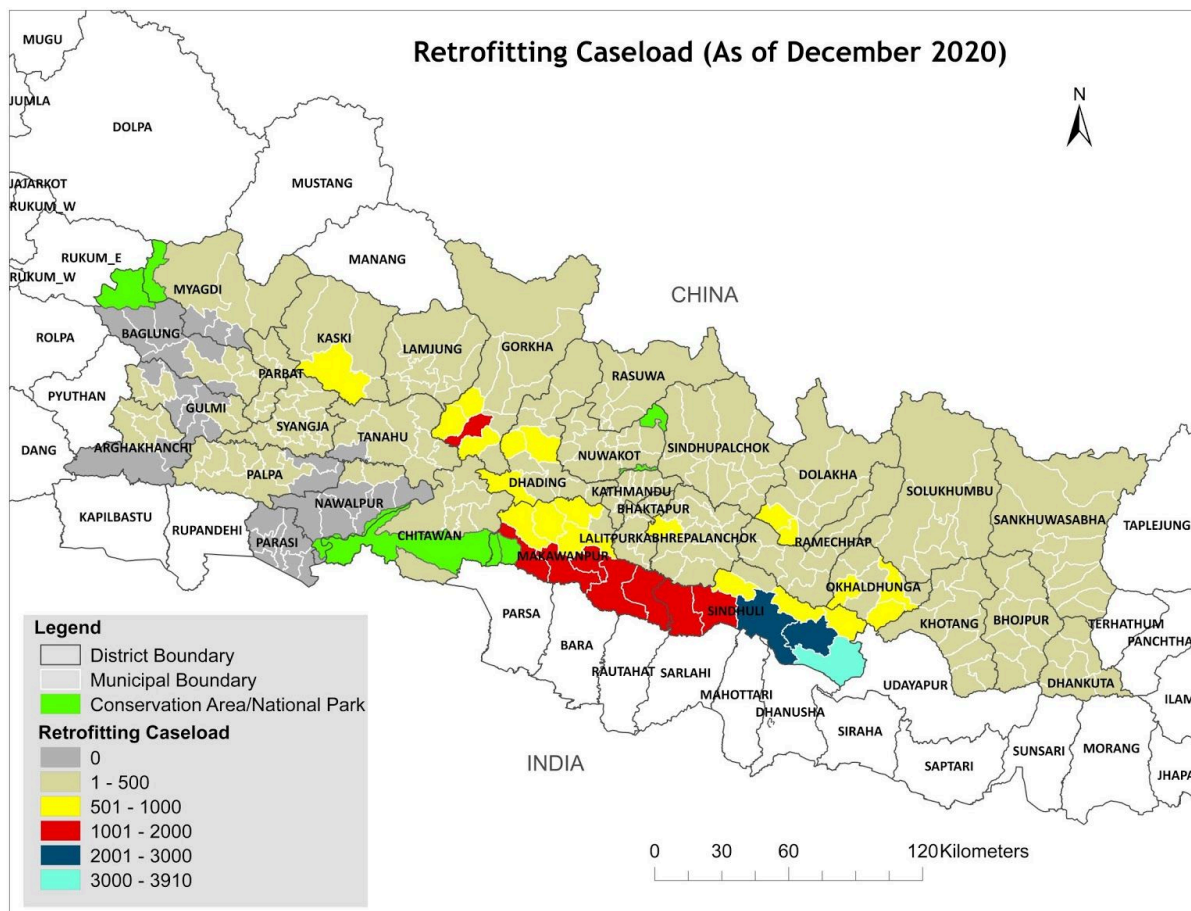
[Monthly e-newsletter of NRA November 2020](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS

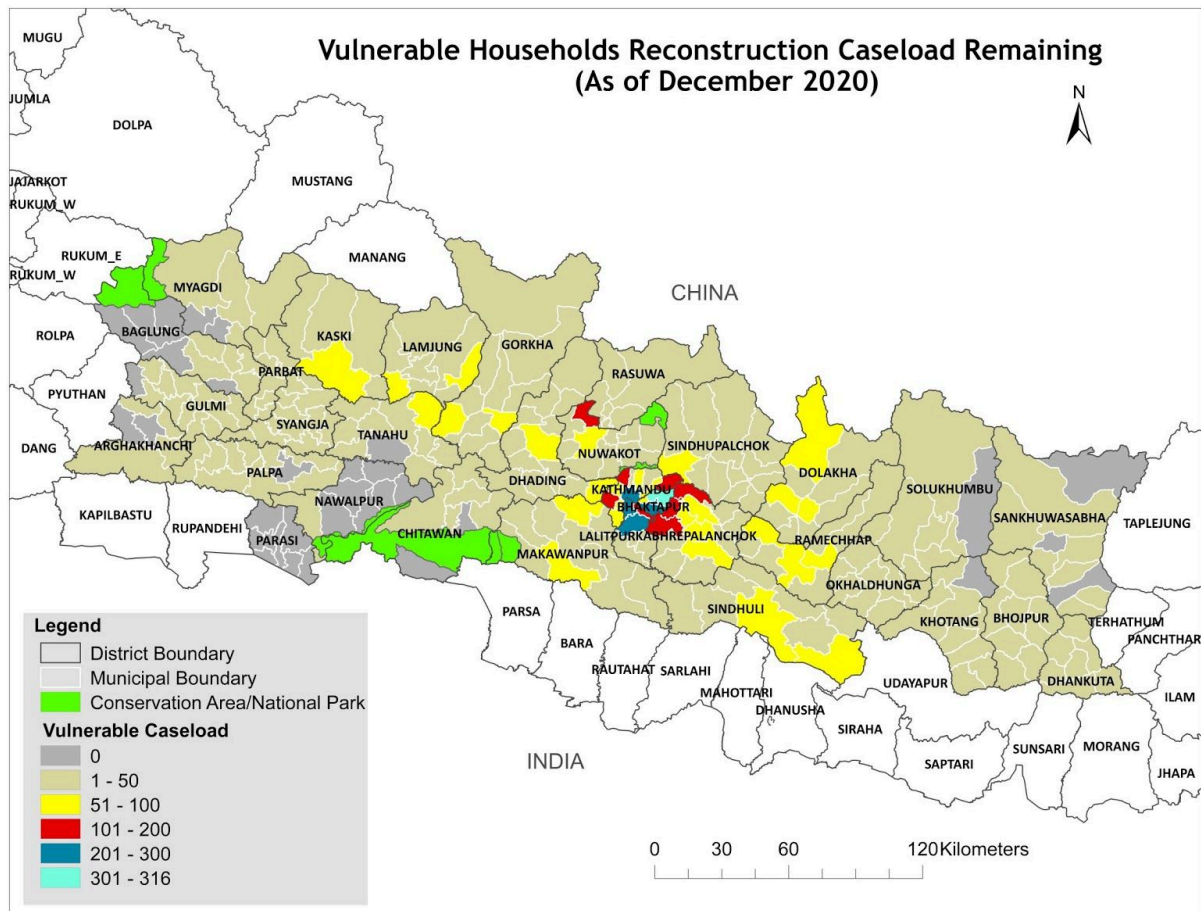
Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (December 2020)



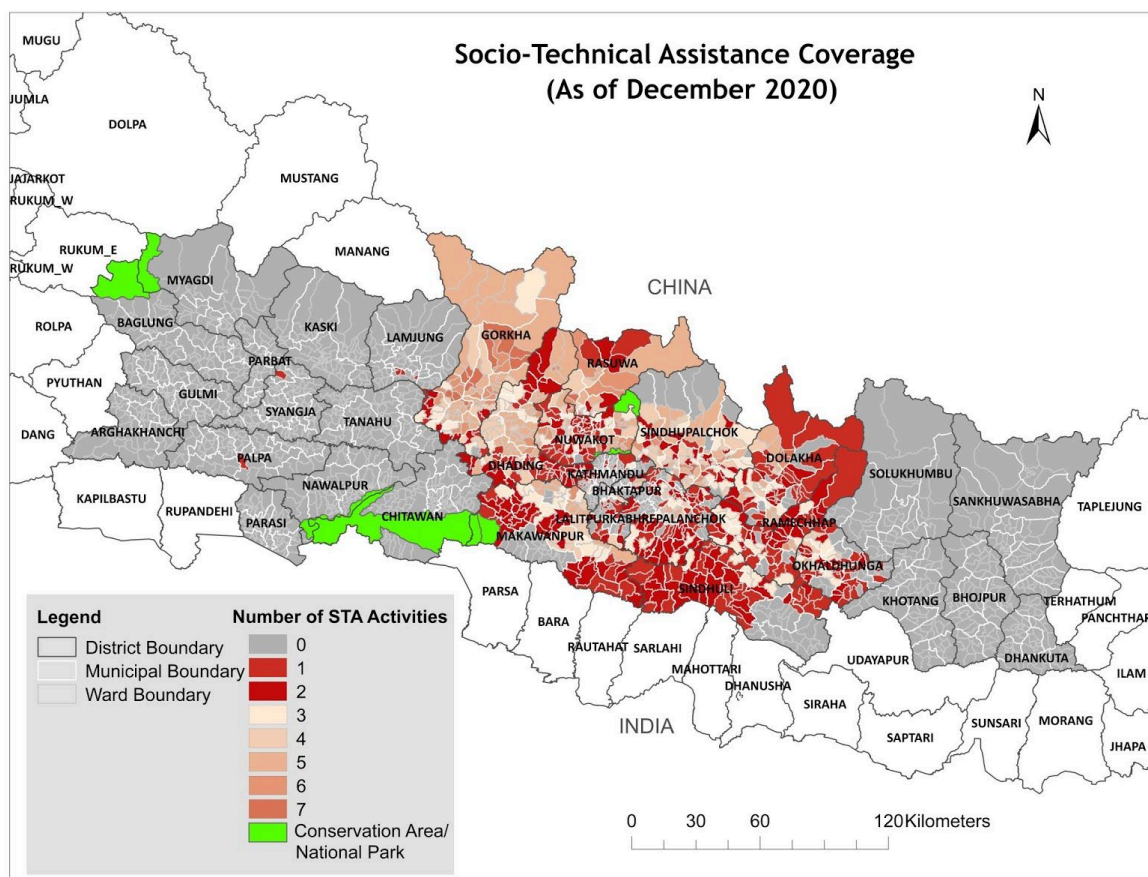
Retrofitting Caseload Remaining (December 2020)



Vulnerable Households Reconstruction Caseload Remaining (December 2020)



Coverage of Socio Technical Assistance (December 2020): This is based on 5W data collection, December 2020.



PARTNER PRODUCTS

Using the Sphere Standards in Urban Settings: Applying humanitarian standards in urban situations has been a challenge for a long time. This guide provides practical guidance on how to do so and seeks to understand how best to integrate the requirements of urban contexts into the 2018 edition of the Sphere Handbook. The guide was updated in 2020. **The second edition is available at this link**



Palika Profiles (Municipal reconstruction profiles)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32 earthquake-affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



Municipal dataset on Reconstruction

CSV, PDF

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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